

Cable

PREC: IMMEDIATE

CLASS: ~~SECRET~~

LINE1: OAASZYUW RUEHCAA4561 2020226-SSSS--RHEHAAX.

LINE2: ZNY SSSSS ZZH

LINE3: O 210226Z JUL 95 ZFF6

LINE4: FM SECSTATE WASHDC

OSRI: RUEHC

DTG: 210226Z JUL 95

ORIG: SECSTATE WASHDC

TO: AMEMBASSY PARIS IMMEDIATE 0000

INFO: /////

SUBJ: SECRETARY'S CONVERSATION WITH FRENCH FM DE
CHARETTE

TEXT:

~~SECRET~~ STATE 174561

QQQQ

NODIS

MERCURY EYES ONLY FOR THE AMBASSADOR FROM EXEC SEC

E.O. 12356: DECL:OADR

TAGS: PREL, PGOV, BK, FR

SUBJECT: SECRETARY'S CONVERSATION WITH FRENCH FM DE
CHARETTE

1. ~~SECRET~~ - ENTIRE TEXT. NODIS MERCURY

2. THIS CABLE CONTAINS A DRAFT MEMORANDUM OF
THE SECRETARY'S TELEPHONE CONVERSATION WITH FM DE CHARETTE
ON JULY 19, 1995. THE SECRETARY INITIATED THE CALL. I
ASK THAT YOU NOT PERMIT COPIES TO BE MADE OF THIS
MESSAGE, AND THAT YOU DO NOT DISTRIBUTE IT OUTSIDE OF
THE MISSION'S EXECUTIVE OFFICE. DEPARTMENT RECIPIENTS
SHOULD NOT DISTRIBUTE OUTSIDE THE BUREAU'S FRONT OFFICE.

3. BEGIN TEXT:

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

DATE: WEDNESDAY, JULY 19, 1995

TIME: 1935 EDT

PARTICIPANTS: THE SECRETARY AND FM DE CHARETTE

SUBJECT: DE CHARETTE WORRIES ABOUT LACK OF
CONSENSUS AT JULY 21 LONDON MEETING ON
BOSNIA

THE SECRETARY ASKED IF FM DE CHARETTE INTENDS TO BE AT
THE LONDON MEETING. DE CHARETTE, WHO IS ACCOMPANYING
CHIRAC IN MORRBCO, SAID HE WOULD NOT ARRIVE IN LONDON
BEFORE MIDNIGHT, JULY 20. THE SECRETARY THEN ASKED IF

DECLASSIFIED
PER E.O. 13526

2013-0517-M (1.01)

KBH 7/14/2019

DE CHARETTE WOULD BE ABLE TO TAKE A CONFERENCE CALL FROM BOTH THE SECRETARY AND FM RIFKIND DURING THE AFTERNOON OF JULY 20. DE CHARETTE RESPONDED THAT HE WOULD WELCOME SUCH A CALL.

DE CHARETTE THEN SAID HE WISHED TO MAKE SEVERAL CONCERNS KNOWN TO THE SECRETARY PRIOR TO THE LATTER'S DEPARTURE FOR THE AIRPORT. HE IS WORRIED ABOUT THE UPCOMING LONDON MEETING AND FEARS THE U.S., U.K. AND FRANCE MAY NOT COME TO A UNIFIED DECISION, A DEVELOPMENT THAT WOULD CONSTITUTE A SIGNIFICANT FAILURE OF THE WEST. INTERNATIONAL REPERCUSSIONS FROM SUCH A FAILURE TO AGREE WOULD BE GRAVE. THE FRENCH POSITION HAD BEEN MADE VERY CLEAR DURING THE JULY 19 TELCON BETWEEN PRESIDENTS CLINTON AND CHIRAC. Tw REITERATE, IT IS ABSOLUTELY NECESSARY TO DRAW A LINE AT GORAZDE AND UNPROFOR TROOPS THERE MUST BE REINFORCED.

DE CHARETTE REFERRED TO THE SPECIFIC PROPOSALS THE GOF HAS MADE TO REINFORCE GORAZDE AND SAID FRANCE COULD NOT JOIN IN ANY AGREEMENTS AT THE LONDON MEETING WHICH DID NOT FOLLOW ALONG THOSE LINES. THE U.S. AIR STRIKE OPTION WOULD BE LIMITING AND WOULD NOT DETER THE SERBS FROM GOING INTO GORAZNE. A STRONG MESSAGE MUST BE SENT TO THE SERBS AND CONCRETE MILITARY ACTION IS THE WAY TO SEND SUCH A MESSAGE. DE CHARETTE THEN ASKED FOR THE SECRETARY'S READOUT OF THE CLINTON-CHIRAC CALL.

THE SECRETARY CHARACTERIZED THE PRESIDENTIAL CALL AS POSITIVE. HE WAS ENCOURAGED BY THE MUTUAL UNDERSTANDING THAT THERE MUST BE CHANGES IN THE WEST'S POLICY. NOTING FRENCH AND U.S. AGREEMENT THAT A LINE MUST BE DRAWN AT GORAZDE, THE SECRETARY ALSO UNDERScored COMMON U.S., U.K. AND FRENCH GROUND ON THE NEED FOR A VIGOROUS AIR CAMPAIGN AGAINST THE SERBS SHOULD THEY ATTACK GORAZDE. THE SECRETARY WELCOMED THE CONVERGENCE OF IDEAS AMONG THE THREE COUNTRIES ON HOLDING THE LINE AT GORAZDE AND DETERRING THE SERBS WITH THREATS OF A VIGOROUS AIR CAMPAIGN.

THE SECRETARY SAID U.S. MILITARY LEADERS HAVE STUDIED THE FRENCH PROPOSAL TO REINFORCE THE ENCLAVE WITH 1000 FRENCH TROOPS AND HAVE CONCLUDED IT IS AN UNWISE MOVE. HE STRESSED THIS IS A MILITARY VIEW, AND NOT A POLITICAL ONE. HE REITERATED HIS BELIEF THAT WARNING THE SERBIAN LEADERSHIP PUBLICLY AND PRIVATELY AS TO WHAT AIRSTRIKES COULD DO TO ANY SERBIAN INCURSION FORCE INTO GORAZDE WILL DETER SUCH AN ATTACK BETTER THAN REINFORCEMENT. REINFORCEMENT OF GORAZDE WITH MORE TROOPS IS A SYMBOLIC GESTURE THAT WOULD SURELY HAVE GRAVE CONSEQUENCES.

THE SECRETARY TOLD DE CHARETTE THE WORLD IS LOOKING TO THE PLAYERS AT THE LONDON MEETING TO ACHIEVE A COMMON POSITION. HE ASKED DE CHARETTE TO CONSIDER THE AIR CAMPAIGN OPTION AND SAID HE WOULD DISCUSS OTHER OPTIONS WITH FM RIFKIND IN THE MORNING.

DE CHARETTE THANKED THE SECRETARY.FOR HIS VIEWS BUT

REPEATED HIS CONCERNS ABOUT THE MEETING'S PROSPECTS. THE GOF DOES NOT SEE ANY POSSIBILITY OF GIVING ITS ASSENT TO A DECISION IN LONDON WHICH DOES NOT INCLUDE SOME COMPONENT OF GROUND REINFORCEMENT IN GORAZDE. OF COURSE HE AND OTHER FRENCH OFFICIALS WILL CONTINUE TO EXPLORE OPTIONS AND MAINTAIN CHANNELS OF COMMUNICATION OPEN; HOWEVER, IT IS HIS OPINION THE CHANCES OF REACHING AN AGREEMENT IN LONDON ARE WORSENING.

DE CHARETTE ALSO CONTRADICTED THE SECRETARY'S EARLIER DECLARATION THAT THERE APPEARED TO BE COMMON GROUND AMONG THE U.S., U.K. AND FRANCE ON THE ISSUE OF AIR STRIKES. HE SAID FRANCE HAS NOT AGREED TO AN AIR OPTION AND COULD NOT BE PARTY TO ANY SCENARIO IN WHICH AN AIR CAMPAIGN CONSTITUTES THE WEST'S ONLY RESPONSE TO SERB AGGRESSION IN GORAZDE. HE REITERATED THAT GROUND REINFORCEMENT WAS THE ONLY PRACTICAL MILITARY MOVE WHICH COULD EFFECTIVELY DETER THE SERBS.

THE SECRETARY SAID IT WOULD BE MOST UNFORTUNATE SHOULD THE MEETING NOT PRODUCE AN AGREEMENT. HE URGED DE CHARETTE TO COMMUNICATE TO HIS POLITICAL AND MILITARY COLLEAGUES THE NEED FOR A SUCCESS IN LONDON. THE SECRETARY STRESSED GORAZDE IS A MILITARY PROBLEM; REINFORCEMENT SHOULD BE CONSIDERED IN MILITARY, NOT POLITICAL TERMS.

THE CALL ENDED AT 1927 EDT WITH BOTH PARTIES AGREEING TO SPEAK THURSDAY, JULY 20 IN A CONFERENCE CALL INCLUDING THE BRITISH FOREIGN MINISTER.

4. END TEXT
TALBOTT
BT
#4561

NNNN

SECT: SECTION: 01 OF 01

SSN: 4561

TOR: 950721002106 M1774424

DIST:

PRT: BASS BERGER DOHSE FUERTH HARMON LAKE SENS SIT SODERBERG
SIT: BELL CLARKER HARMON LAKEA SUM SUM2 VERSHBOW WHSR_SPECIAL
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